

Everyone Makes Mistakes

20–25 min · Week 3

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that mistakes are normal and universal, and that a mistake does not mean they are bad.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · growth mindset; separating actions from identity
VOCABULARY	mistake · oops · learning · try again · normal · everyone
MATERIALS	Mentor text: Beautiful Oops! by Barney Saltzberg · Sammy puppet · sticky notes · Mistake Wall space

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Feelings Anchor Chart. "Last lesson: feelings are messengers. Today Sammy makes a mistake." Sammy knocks something over dramatically. "Is Sammy bad — or did he just make a mistake?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Wait — did I make a mistake... or AM I a mistake? Are those the same thing?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1 Sammy's Question 3 MIN

Deliver the distinction: An Oops is something you DID. "I am bad" is about WHO YOU ARE. They are not the same. "Has anyone here ever made a mistake? Does that mean everyone here is bad?" Wait for the laugh.

Sammy: "I made a mistake. But I am still ME. I am not bad — I just had an Oops!"

2 Read-Aloud · Beautiful Oops! 7 MIN

Read Beautiful Oops! by Barney Saltzberg with enthusiasm. After each page: "What happened? Did that turn out to be a bad thing or something surprising?"

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the read-aloud: watch for children whose body language shifts at the word "mistake." Clenching or looking down can indicate shame at home. Do not address publicly. Note for the Teacher Reflection.

3 Mistake Wall 6 MIN

Distribute sticky notes. Each student draws or dictates ONE mistake. Post on the Mistake Wall. "Look at ALL these mistakes — every one made by the amazing people in this room. Mistakes are NORMAL."